

support L2 Networks that span multiple switches. Cisco will offer an OpenStack Quantum Plug-in and REST APIs for its virtual switches to orchestrate multi-tenant cloud infrastructures. Cisco's Cloud CTO and VP, Lew Tucker, was recently elected vice chairman of the OpenStack Foundation.

Cisco is an active participant in the Open Networking Foundation (ONF) as well. Cisco Open Network Environment (ONE), a comprehensive initiative targeted at network programmability complementing an overarching cloud platform, aims to deliver amongst other features:

- (a) open APIs across Cisco's operating systems (Cisco IOS, IOS-XR and NX-OS); and
- (b) proof-of-concept controller software and OpenFlow agents for software-defined networking research.

Leading clients: The key industry verticals in which Cisco has seen maximum traction are ITeS, FSI, manufacturing and government. In addition to this, the company has partnered with several service providers to provide cloud computing services to SMEs.

USP: Because of its networking heritage and the strength of its core networking business, the company is in the best position to help customers realise the benefits of the cloud. This market position allows Cisco to highlight its innovation and leadership – organically and with partners – as part of its strategy.

Website: <http://www.cisco.com/web/IN/index.html>

VMware Software India Pvt Ltd | Bengaluru, India

The company provides solutions across the three layers of IT environment: infrastructure, application and end-user computing, and thus helps its customers adopt a complete cloud environment.

VMware cloud solutions improve IT efficiency, agility and reliability, while helping IT drive innovation. VMware delivers everything IT needs to build, operate, staff and manage the cloud, while continuously quantifying its impact. VMware helps customers evolve technical foundations, organisational models, operational processes and financial measures to establish both a cloud infrastructure and cloud operations model that delivers the greatest benefit from cloud computing. VMware cloud solutions maximise the potential of cloud computing to deliver new IT services that fuel business growth. It also helps create and rapidly deploy services that differentiate the business and transform IT into a source of innovation. VMware Cloud Operations Services provide organisations with insight, prioritised recommendations, and expert guidance.

Major open source-based offerings: VMware has a long history of support for open source software in its products. In addition to collaborating with the open source community, VMware works closely with major Linux vendors to ensure high quality support for Linux guest operating systems running on VMware hypervisors. As an active participant in the open source community, VMware has open sourced the VMware Tools as the Open Virtual Machine Tools project, contributed the VMI (Virtual Machine Interface) para-virtualisation code under the GPL, collaborated with the Linux kernel community and others in the development of paravirt-ops, and sponsored OSD's DCL F2F.

Leading clients: The company has more than 1800 customers across verticals in India, which include HPCL Mittal Energy, Dhanalaxmi Bank, CRISIL, HDFC Bank, Axis Bank, Tata Communication and KPIT Cummins.

Website: <http://www.vmware.com/in>

Sify | Chennai, India

The company's Cloudinfini offers enterprise grade IaaS and PaaS services on a pay-per-use basis through its online cloud portal, www.cloudinfini.com. Cloudinfini offers ready-to-use compute instances on a multi-tenant, robust and fully scalable infrastructure to host the most demanding e-business applications in an enterprise grade, secure, highly available and self-controlled environment backed with stringent service level guarantees. The services include wide choices across computing, storage, networking, security, analytics and the protection product stack, to provide end-to-end IT infrastructure on a pay-per-use basis.

The cloud services are highly scalable and resilient, while ensuring rapid deployment.

Major open source-based offerings: The company provides PaaS services like Ubuntu, Linux and over 80 operating system variants. In SaaS, the company offers Sify Mail, Sify forum software that are available for the open source community, etc.

Leading clients: The company has provided cloud services to over 125 leading companies from the BFSI, retail, IT, textiles, manufacturing and government sectors.

USP: Sify has successfully leveraged its strengths (the network, hosting, security, professional services and